

The Testimony of Truth

IX 29,6-74,30

I will speak to those who know to hear not with the ears of the body but with the ears of the mind. For many have sought after the truth and have not been able to find it; because there has taken hold of them [the] old leaven of the Pharisees and the scribes [of] the Law. And the leaven is [the] errant desire of the angels and the demons and the stars. As for the Pharisees and the scribes, it is they who belong to the archons who have authority [over them].

For no one who is under the Law will be able to look up to the truth for they will not be able to serve two masters. For the defilement of the Law is manifest; but undefilement belongs to the light. The Law commands (one) to take a husband (or) to take a wife, and to beget, to multiply like the sand of the sea. But passion which is a delight to them constrains the souls of those who are begotten in this place, those who defile and those who are defiled, in order that the Law might be fulfilled through them. And they show that they are assisting the world; and they [turn] away from the light, who are unable [to pass by] the archon of [darkness] until they pay the last [penny].

But the Son of Man [came] forth from Imperishability, [being] alien to defilement. He came [to the] world by the Jordan river, and immediately the Jordan [turned] back. And John bore witness to the [descent] of Jesus. For it is he who saw the [power] which came down upon the Jordan river; for he knew that the dominion of carnal procreation had come to an end. The Jordan river is the power of the body, that is, the senses of pleasures. The water of the Jordan is the desire for sexual intercourse. John is the archon of the womb.

And this is what the Son of Man reveals to us: It is fitting for you (pl.) to receive the word of truth. If one will receive it perfectly, ... But as for one who is [in] ignorance, it is difficult for him to diminish his works of [darkness] which he has done. Those who have [known] Imperishability, [however], have been able to struggle against [passions ...] I have said [to you], “Do not build [nor] gather for yourselves in the [place] where the brigands break open, but bring forth fruit to the Father.”

The foolish—thinking [in] their heart [that] if they confess, “We are Christians,” in word only (but) not with power, while giving themselves over to ignorance, to a human death, not knowing where they are going nor who Christ is, thinking that they will live, when they are (really) in error—hasten towards the principalities and the authorities. They fall into their clutches because of the ignorance that is in them. For (if) only words which bear testimony were effecting salvation, the whole world would endure this thing [and] would be saved. [But it is in this way that they [drew] error to themselves. [... they do] not [know] that they [will destroy] themselves. If the [Father were to] desire a [human] sacrifice, he would become [vainglorious].]

For the Son of [Man] clothed himself with their first-fruits; he went down to Hades and performed many mighty works. He raised the dead therein; and the world-rulers of darkness became envious of him, for they did not find sin in him. But he also destroyed their works from among men, so that the lame, the blind, the paralytic, the dumb, (and) the demon-possessed were granted healing. And he walked upon the waters of the sea. For this reason he [destroyed] his flesh from [...] which he [...]. And he [became ...] salvation [...] his death ... everyone [...] how many [they are! They are] blind [guides, like the disciples]. They boarded [the ship, (and) at about thirty]

stades, they [saw Jesus walking] on the [sea. These] are [empty] martyrs, since they bear witness only [to] themselves. And yet they are sick, and they are not able to raise themselves.

But when they are “perfected” with a (martyr’s) death, this is the thought that they have within them: “If we deliver ourselves over to death for the sake of the Name we will be saved.” These matters are not settled in this way. But through the agency of the wandering stars they say that they have “completed” their [futile] “course,” and [...] say, [...]. But these [...] they have [delivered themselves ...]. But they resemble [...] them. They do not have the word which gives [life].

[And] some say, “On the last day [we will] certainly arise [in the] resurrection.” But they do not [know what] they are saying, for the last day [is when] those belonging to Christ [... the] earth which is [...]. When the [time] was fulfilled, he destroyed [their archon] of [darkness ...] soul(s) [... he stood ...] they asked [what they have been] bound with, [and how they] might properly [release themselves]. And [they came to know] themselves, [(as to) who they are], or rather, where they are [now], and what is the [place] in which they will rest from their senselessness, [arriving] at knowledge. [These] Christ will transfer to [the heights] since they have [renounced] foolishness, (and have) advanced to knowledge. And those who [have knowledge ...] the great [... the resurrection ... he has come to] know [the Son of Man], that is, he has come to know [himself]. [This] is the perfect life, [that] man know [himself] by means of the All.

[Do not] expect, therefore, [the] carnal resurrection, which [is] destruction, [and they are not] stripped of [it (the flesh) who] err in [expecting] a [resurrection] that is empty. [They do] not [know] the power [of God], nor do they [understand the interpretation] of the scriptures [on account of their] double-mindedness. [The mystery] which [the Son of Man spoke about ...] in order that [...] destroy [...] man who [...] book] which is written [...] for [they] have [... blessed ...] within [them, and they] dwell before [God under the light yoke. Those who do not] have [the life-giving word] in their [heart will die]; and in [their] thought they have become manifest to [the Son] of Man, according to [the manner of their] activity and their [error ...] of this sort. They [...] as he divides the [...] and they [do not] understand [that the Son] of Man is coming from him.

But [when they have come] up to [...] sacrifice, they die [in a] human [way], and they [deliver] themselves [...] a death [...] those who [...] they are many [...] each [one ...] pervert [...] gain [...] their] mind. [Those who receive him] to themselves [with uprightness] and [power] and every knowledge [are the ones whom] he will transfer [to the] heights, unto [life] eternal.

[But] those who receive [him] to themselves with [ignorance], the pleasures which are defiled prevail over [them]. It is those people who used to [say], “God created [members] for our use, for us to [grow in] defilement, in order that [we might] enjoy [ourselves].” And they cause [God to] participate with them [in] deeds of this sort; and they are [not] steadfast [upon] the earth. [Nor will they reach] heaven, [but ...] place will [...] four [...] unquenchable [...] word [...] upon [the Jordan river] when he came [to John at] the time he [was baptized]. The [Holy] Spirit [came] down upon him [as a] dove [...] accept for ourselves that [he] was born of a virgin [and] he took flesh; he [...] having] received power. [Were we also begotten from] a virginal state [or] conceived by the word? [Rather, we have been born] again by [the word]. Let us therefore strengthen [ourselves] as virgins in the [...].

The males dwell [...] the virgin by means of [...] in the word [...]. But the word of [...] and spirit [...] is the Father [...] for the man [...] like Isaiah, who was sawed with a saw, (and) he be-

came two. [So also the Son of Man divides] us by [the word of the] cross. It [divides the day from] the night and [the light from the] darkness and the corruptible [from] incorruptibility, and it [divides] the males from the females.

But [Isaiah] is the type of the body. The saw is the word of the Son of Man which separates us from the error of the angels.

No one knows the God of truth except solely the man who will forsake all of the things of the world, having renounced the whole place, (and) having grasped the fringe of his garment. He has set himself up as a [power]; he has subdued desire in every [way] within himself. He has [...] and he has turned to him [...] having also examined [...] in becoming [...] the mind. And [he ... from] his soul [...] there [...] he has [...] in what way [...] the flesh which [...] in what way [...] out of it, and how many [powers does he have]? And who is the one who has bound him? And who is the one who will loose him? And what is the light? And what is the darkness? And who is the one who has created [the earth]? And who is God? [And who] are the angels? And what is soul? And what is spirit? And where is the voice? And who is the one who speaks? And who is the one who hears? Who is the one who gives pain? And who is the one who suffers? And who is it who has begotten the corruptible flesh? And what is the governance? And why are some lame, and some [blind], and some [...], and some [...], and some rich, [and] some poor? And why are [some powerless, some] brigands? [...] he having [...] as he again [...] fighting against [thoughts] of the archons and the powers and the demons, not giving them a place in which to rest. [But] he struggled against their passions [...] he condemned their error. He cleansed his soul from the transgressions which he had committed with an alien hand. He stood up, being upright within himself, because he exists in everyone, and because he has death and life within himself, and he exists in the midst of both of them. And when he had received the power he turned towards the parts of the right, and he entered into the truth, having forsaken all things pertaining to the left, having been filled with wisdom, with counsel, with understanding and with insight, and an eternal power. [And] he broke open his bonds. [Those who had] formed the whole place [he] condemned. [But they did not] find [...] hidden within him.

[And he gave command] to himself; he [began to] know [himself and] to speak with his [mind], which is the father of the truth, concerning the unbegotten aeons, and concerning the virgin who brought forth the light. And he thinks about the power which flowed over the [whole] place, and which takes hold of him. And he is a disciple of his mind which is male. He began to keep silent within himself until the day when he should become worthy to be received above. He rejects for himself loquacity and disputations, and he endures the whole place; and he bears up under them, and he endures all of the evil things. And he is patient with every one; he makes himself equal to every one, and he also separates himself from them. And that which someone [wants, he brings] to him, [in order that] he might become perfect [(and) holy]. When the [... he] grasped [him], having bound him upon [...] and he was filled [with wisdom. He] bore witness to the truth [...] the power, and he went [into] Imperishability, the place whence he [came] forth, having left the world which has the appearance of the [night, and] those that whirl the [stars in] it.

This, therefore, is the true testimony: When man comes to know himself and God who is over the truth, he will be saved, and he will crown himself with the crown unfading.

John was begotten by the World through a woman, Elizabeth; and Christ was begotten by the world through a virgin, Mary. What is (the meaning of) this mystery? John was begotten by means of a womb worn with age, but Christ passed through a virgin's womb. When she had conceived she gave birth to the Savior. Furthermore she was found to be a virgin again. Why, then, do you (pl.) [err] and not seek after these mysteries which were prefigured for our sake?

It is written in the Law concerning this, when God gave a command to Adam, "From every [tree] you may eat, [but] from the tree which is in the midst of Paradise do not eat, for on the day that you eat from it you will surely die." But the serpent was wiser than all the animals that were in Paradise, and he persuaded Eve, saying, "On the day when you eat from the tree which is in the midst of Paradise the eyes of your mind will be opened." And Eve obeyed, and she stretched forth her hand; she took from the tree and ate; she also gave to her husband with her. And immediately they knew that they were naked, and they took some fig leaves (and) put them on as girdles.

But [God] came at the time of [evening] walking in the midst [of] Paradise. When Adam saw him he hid himself. And he said, "Adam, where are you?" He answered (and) said, "[I] have come under the fig tree." And at that very moment God [knew] that he had eaten from the tree of which he had commanded him, "Do not eat of it." And he said to him, "Who is it who has instructed you?" And Adam answered, "The woman whom you have given me." And the woman said, "It is the serpent who instructed me." And he cursed the serpent, and called him "devil." And he said, "Behold, Adam has become like one of us, knowing evil and good." Then he said, "Let us cast him out of Paradise lest he take from the tree of life and eat and live for ever."

But of what sort is this God? First [he] maliciously refused Adam from eating of the tree of knowledge. And secondly he said, "Adam, where are you?" God does not have foreknowledge; (otherwise), would he not know from the beginning? [And] afterwards he said, "Let us cast him [out] of this place, lest he eat of the tree of life and live for ever." Surely he has shown himself to be a malicious grudger.

And what kind of a God is this? For great is the blindness of those who read, and they did not know him. And he said, "I am the jealous God; I will bring the sins of the fathers upon the children until three (and) four generations." And he said, "I will make their heart thick, and I will cause their mind to become blind, that they might not know nor comprehend the things that are said." But these things he has said to those who believe in him [and] serve him!

And [in one] place Moses writes, "[He] made the devil a serpent [those] whom he has in his generation." Also in the book which is called "Exodus," it is written thus (cf. 7:8-12): "He contended against the [magicians], when the place was full [of serpents] according to their [wickedness; and the rod] which was in the hand of Moses became a serpent, (and) it swallowed the serpents of the magicians."

Again it is written (Nm 21:9), "He made a serpent of bronze (and) hung it upon a pole [...] which [...] for the [one who will gaze] upon [this] bronze [serpent], none [will destroy] him, and the one who will [believe in] this bronze serpent [will be saved]."

For this is Christ; [those who] believed in him [have received life]. Those who did not believe [will die].

What, then, is this [faith? They] do not [serve ... and you (pl.) ...] we [...] and] you [do not understand Christ spiritually when you say], "We [believe] in Christ." For [this] is the [way] Moses

[writes] in every book. The [book of the] generation of Adam [is written for those] who are in the [generation] of [the Law]. They follow the Law [and] they obey it, [and ...] together with the [...].

(pp. 51-54 almost completely missing)

[... , "... the] Ogdoad, which is the eighth, and that we might receive that [place] of salvation." [But they] know not what salvation is, but they enter into [misfortune] and into a [...] in death, in the [waters]. This [is] the baptism [of death which they observe ...] come to death [... and] this is [...] according to [...] he completed the course [of] Valentinus. He himself speaks about the Ogdoad, and his disciples resemble [the] disciples of Valentinus. They on their part, moreover, [...] leave the good, [but] they have [worship of] the idols [...] he has spoken [many words, and he has] written many [books ...] words [...] they are] manifest from [the] confusion in which they are, [in the] deceit of the world. For [they] go to that place together with their knowledge [which is] vain.

Isidore also, [his son], resembled [Basilides]. He also [...] many, and [he ...] but he did not [...] this [...] other disciple(s) [...] blind [...] [but he] gave them [... pleasures ...] they do [not] agree [with] each other. For the [Simonians] take [wives] (and) beget children; but the [...] abstain from their [...] nature [...] a [passion ...] the drops [of ...] anoint [them ...] which we [...] they agree with [each other ...] him [...] they [...] judgment(s) [...] these, on account of the [...] them [...] the heretics [...] schism(s) [...] and the males [...] are men [...] will belong [to the world-rulers] of darkness [...] of [the world ...] they have [...] the [archons ... power(s) ...] judge [them ...]. But [the ...] word(s) of [...] speak, while they [...] become [...] in a fire [unquenchable ...] they are punished.

[But these] who are [from the generation] of the Son of [Man have revealed] to the [... in] all of [the affairs ...]. But [it is difficult] to [...] to find [one ...] and [two ...]. For the [Savior said to his] disciples, [...] one in [...] and] he has [...] wisdom as well as [counsel and] understanding and [intelligence] and knowledge [and power] and truth. [And he has] some [...] from above [...] the place where [the Son of Man ...] power [...] guard against [...] he knows [...] understands [...] worthy of him [...] true [...] alien [...]. But [...], together with [...] evil, in [...] he received [baptism ...] and those that [...] (pp. 63-64 missing) [...] in a dream [...] silver [...]. But [...] becomes [wealthy ...] among the [authorities ...]. But [the] sixtieth [...] thus [...] world [...] they [...] gold [...] they] think, [...] we have been released from the flesh. [...] not turn him to [...] Jesus [...] the] beginning [...] a son [...] out of [...] which is] the pattern [...] light of [...] to find from [...] defilement which [...] they] do not blaspheme [...]

[... them] not, neither is there any [pleasure] nor desire, nor [can they] control them. It is fitting that they should become undefiled, in order that they might [show] to every [one] that they [are from] the [generation of the] Son of Man, since it is about [them] that the Savior bore witness.

But [those who are] from the seed [of Adam] are manifest by their [deeds which are] their [work]. They have not ceased [from desire which is wicked ...]. But some [...] the dogs [...] the angels for [...] which they beget [...] will come [...] with their [...] move as they [...] on] the day when they will beget [children]. Not only that, but they have intercourse while they are giving suck.

But others are caught up in the death of [...]. They are [pulled] which way, (and) they are gratified by unrighteous Mammon. They lend money [at interest]; they [waste time]; and they do not work. But he who is [father] of Mammon is (also) (the) father of sexual intercourse.

But he who is able to renounce them shows [that] he is [from] the generation of the [Son of Man], (and) has power to accuse [them ... he] restrains [...] part(s) in a [...] in wickedness [and he makes] the outer like the [inner. He resembles] an angel which [...] power [...] said them. But the one [...]. And having withdrawn [...] he became silent, having ceased from loquacity and disputations.

But he [who has] found the [life-giving word and he who] has come to know [the Father of Truth has come to rest]; he has ceased [seeking], having [found]. And when he found he became [silent]. But few are the things he used to say to those that [...] with their intellectual mind the [...].

There are some who, upon entering the faith, receive a baptism on the ground that they have [it] as a hope of salvation, which they call “the [seal],” not [knowing] that the [fathers of] the world are manifest that place. But he himself [knows that] he is sealed. For [the Son] of [Man] did not baptize any of his disciples. But [...] if those who] are baptized were headed for life, the world would become empty. And the fathers of baptism were defiled.

But the baptism of truth is something else; it is by renunciation of [the] world that it is found. [But those who] say [only] with the tongue [that they] are renouncing it [are lying], and they are coming to [the place] of fear. Moreover they are humbled within it. Just as those to whom it was given, to have been condemned, [they shall] get something!

They are wicked in their behavior! Some of them fall away [to the worship of] idols. [Others] have [demons] dwelling with them [as did] David the king. He is the one who laid the foundation of Jerusalem; and his son Solomon, whom he begat in [adultery], is the one who built Jerusalem by means of the demons, because he received [power]. When he [had finished building, he imprisoned] the demons [in the temple]. He [placed them] into seven [waterpots. They remained] a long [time in] the [waterpots], abandoned [there]. When the Romans [went] up to [Jerusalem] they discovered [the] waterpots, [and immediately] the [demons] ran out of the waterpots as those who escape from prison. And the waterpots [remained] pure (thereafter). [And] since those days, [they dwell] with men who are [in] ignorance, and [they have remained upon] the earth.

Who, then, is [David]? And who is Solomon? [And] what is the foundation? And what is the wall which surrounds Jerusalem? And who are the demons? And what are the waterpots? And who are the Romans? But these [are mysteries ...] victorious over [...] the Son] of Man [...] undefiled [...] and he [...] when he [...]. For [...] is a great [...] to this nature [...] those that [...] all in [a ...] blessed and they [...] like a] salamander. [It] goes into the flaming fire which burns exceedingly; it slithers into the [furnace ... the] furnace [...] the boundaries [...] that they might see [...] and the power [...] sacrifice. Great is the sacrifice [...] but] in a [...] aside [...]. And [the Son] of Man [...] and [he has become] manifest through the bubbling fountain of [immortality. ...], he is pure, [and he] is [...]. A free man [is not] envious. He is set apart from everyone, from [every audacity and] envy the [power of] which is great [...] is (a) disciple [...] pattern of law [...] these [...] only [...] they placed him under a [...] a teaching [...] his teaching, saying, “[Even if] an [angel] comes from heaven, and preaches to you beyond that which we preached to you, may he be anathema,” (cf. Ga 1:8) not letting the [...] of the soul which [...] freedom [...]. For they are still immature [...] they are not able to [keep] this law which works by means of these heresies—though it is not they, but the powers of Sabaoth—by means of the [...] the doctrines [...] as they have been jealous of some [...] law(s)] in Christ. Those who will [...] power [...] they reach the [...] the [twelve] judge [...]

them [...] the fountain of [immortality ...] in order that [... good ...] the whole place. [...] there the enemies. He baptized himself, and the [...] he became divine; he flew [up], (and) they did not grasp him. [...] there the [enemies ...] since it was not possible [for them to bring him] down again. If every [...] grasps him [with] ignorance, attending to those who teach in the corners by means of carved things and artful tricks, they will not be able [...].